

Qijia Zhou

qijia.zhou@cfa.harvard.edu

Education

Harvard University
PhD in Astronomy & Astrophysics

Cambridge, MA
September 2024 – Present

Harvard University
A.B. Physics & Astrophysics
Summa Cum Laude – GPA: 3.99/4.0

Cambridge, MA
September 2020 – May 2024

Honors

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship	2024
Carol Davis Prize for service to the community, Harvard Department of Physics	2024
AAS Chambliss Astronomy Achievement Award, Honorable Mention	2024
Leo Goldberg Prize for best junior thesis, Harvard Department of Astronomy	2023

Publications

- Q. Zhou**, D. W. Latham, S. N. Quinn, A. Bieryla, A. Vanderburg, P. Berlind, M. L. Calkins, and G. A. Esquerdo. False Planets around Giant Stars: A Case Study of Sanders 364 in M67. *The Astronomical Journal*, 166(4):160, Oct. 2023. doi: 10.3847/1538-3881/acf291.
- Q. Zhou**, A. Simon, K. I. Öberg, and M. Rajappan. Competitive Entrapment of Hypervolatiles in Interstellar and Cometary Water Ice Analogs. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 972(2):189, Sept. 2024. doi: 10.3847/1538-4357/ad6322.

Presentations

Talks:

Externally Irradiated Disk Chemistry with JWST ACS Spring 2026 Meeting, The Icy Universe Revealed By JWST. Atlanta, GA.	March 2026
Planet Formation Chemistry in “Normal” Irradiated Environments Center for Astrophysics Harvard & Smithsonian Exoplanet Talk series. Cambridge, MA.	October 2025
Understanding Ice Chemistry in Space and the Role of Laboratory Experiments Harvard Astronomy Student-Faculty Forum. Cambridge, MA.	March 2025
A Solar Eclipse Double Header Gloucester Area Astronomy Club meeting. Gloucester, MA.	November 2023
A Solar Eclipse Double Header Amateur Telescope Makers of Boston meeting. Cambridge, MA.	October 2023
False Planets around Giant Stars Center for Astrophysics Harvard & Smithsonian Exoplanet Talk series. Cambridge, MA.	April 2023

Posters:

Protoplanetary Disk Chemistry in Irradiated Environments Gordon Research Conference, 2025 Origins of Solar Systems. Mount Holyoke College, MA.	June 2025
Competitive Hypervolatile Entrapment in Interstellar and Cometary Ices AAS 243rd meeting. New Orleans, LA.	January 2024
Competitive Hypervolatile Entrapment in Interstellar and Cometary Ices AAS 241st meeting. Seattle, WA.	January 2023
False Planets around Giant Stars: A Case Study of Sanders 364 AAS 240th meeting. Pasadena, CA.	June 2022

Research

Center for Astrophysics | Harvard & Smithsonian

Senior Thesis Researcher

Advisor: Dr. Daniel Fabricant

Cambridge, MA

September 2023 – April 2024

Center for Astrophysics | Harvard & Smithsonian

Student Researcher

Advisor: Dr. Karin Öberg

Cambridge, MA

September 2022 – December 2023

Duke University/Triangle Universities Nuclear Laboratory (TUNL)

NSF REU Researcher

Advisor: Dr. Richard Longland

Durham, NC

May 2023 – August 2023

Center for Astrophysics | Harvard & Smithsonian

Research Intern

Advisor: Dr. David Latham

Cambridge, MA

May 2021 – May 2023

Teaching

Harvard College

Stellar and Planetary Astronomy Teaching Fellow

Cambridge, MA

January 2026 – May 2026

Harvard College

Astronomy Course Assistant

Cambridge, MA

January 2023 – May 2023

Harvard Summit for Young Leaders in China

Seminar Instructor

Shanghai, China

July 2022 (remote) & August 2023

Harvard College

Physics Laboratory Course Assistant

Cambridge, MA

September 2022 – December 2022

Leadership & Community

Dunster House

Resident Tutor: Fellowships, House Committee, and Consent Advocacy Committees

Cambridge, MA

January 2025 – Present

Harvard Planetary Journal Club

Organizer

Cambridge, MA

January 2025 – Present

Astronomy on Tap Boston

Organizer

Cambridge, MA

September 2024 – Present

Astronomy Graduate Student Congress

Harvard Representative

United States

October 2024 – October 2025

Pforzheimer House

Non-Resident Tutor: Fellowships and Graduate School Committees

Cambridge, MA

September 2024 – May 2025

Harvard-Radcliffe Society of Physics Students

Polaris Mentor (2024-Present), President (2022-2023), Events & Panels Chair (2021-2022)

Cambridge, MA

May 2021 – Present

NASA Partner Eclipse Ambassador Program

Undergraduate Ambassador

Selected to represent the Eclipse Ambassadors program in Junction, TX during totality.

Greater Boston

September 2022 – April 2024

Harvard Undergraduate Ethics Bowl

Vice President

Cambridge, MA

June 2020 – February 2023

Harvard International Review

Executive Content Editor

Cambridge, MA

September 2020 – September 2023

Programming

Python (NumPy, SciPy, Matplotlib, Astropy), Linux, C, MATLAB, Mathematica

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (fluent)